

Craft Beer Industry Trends Report - 2025 Annual

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Executive summary

U.S. craft beer volume declined 3.1% in 2025 vs 2024, the third consecutive year of negative volume growth. Number of operating craft breweries reached 9,612 (+0.4% YoY), driven almost entirely by taproom-only and contract openings. Closures hit 502, a post-2014 high. Segment leaders: non-alcoholic craft (+22.4%), hard seltzer co-pack (+8.1%); segment laggards: session IPA (-9.6%), pumpkin seasonal (-14.0%).

Regional snapshot - Carolinas

Metric	NC	SC
Operating breweries (2025)	412	146
Net new openings	+9	+3
Closures	21	9
Avg BBL/brewery	1,820	1,640
Tourism BBL share	21.2%	18.4%

Headwinds & tailwinds

Headwinds: persistent post-2022 input inflation (malt, glass, aluminum), tightening distributor consolidation, generational softness in 21-29 cohort beer share. Tailwinds: barrel-aged and traditional lager interest, premiumization at the high end, agritourism crossover.

Report is for member background only; no action required.